

ON TECHNIQUE

Combining influences

Tchaikovsky blended, seemingly effortlessly, the European influences of Mozartian structures, Chopinesque sensibility, and Wagnerian power with distinctive Russian elements: for example, melodies influenced by the flow of the Russian language and folk song, and by the rich a cappella harmonies of Orthodox church choirs. His music is therefore often seen to bridge a gap between East and West. This, combined with his highly imaginative, colorful orchestration, creates a musical language that has virtually universal appeal.



CHORISTERS IN THE CHURCH, VLADIMIR
EGOROVIC MAKOVSKY, 1870

A doomed marriage

Another crisis arose in Tchaikovsky's personal life soon after